Metroville Public Transit Guide

A Fictional Knowledge Base for RAG Practice

Welcome to Metroville Transit

Purpose

This guide explains how to use the fictional Metroville public transportation network, including metro trains, buses, fares, passes, accessibility, service updates, lost property, and passenger support.

Network overview

Metroville Transit operates the Blue Metro Line, Green Metro Line, local buses, express buses, and a weekend ferry. The Blue and Green lines intersect at Central Exchange. Bus routes use numbers; express routes begin with X.

Important note

Metroville and all routes, prices, policies, and contact details in this learning document are fictional. This document is for practicing retrieval-augmented generation (RAG), not for real travel.

Metro Network and Stations

Blue Line

The Blue Line runs from Northgate to Harbor Point. Major stations are Northgate, Museum Square, Central Exchange, Civic Center, Riverside, and Harbor Point. Typical end-to-end travel time is 38 minutes.

Green Line

The Green Line runs from West Park to East Market. Major stations are West Park, University, Central Exchange, Old Town, and East Market. Typical end-to-end travel time is 31 minutes.

Transfers and facilities

Passengers can transfer between the Blue and Green lines inside Central Exchange without exiting the paid area. Museum Square has public restrooms; Central Exchange has the customer service desk; Riverside has bicycle lockers. Not every station has an elevator.

Bus Services and Route Types

Local buses

Route 14 connects Northgate with Civic Center. Route 22 connects University with Riverside. Route 31 connects Old Town with Harbor Point. Local buses stop at most signed stops.

Express buses

X5 runs from Northgate to Central Exchange during weekday peak periods. X8 connects West Park with East Market on weekdays. Express buses make fewer stops.

Boarding and stop requests

Allow passengers to exit first and board through the front door unless marked all-door boarding. Tap a card or show a valid pass. Press the stop button after the bus leaves the stop before your destination.

Fares: Single Journeys

Standard fare

A single adult journey costs 2.50 Metro Credits. It allows transfers within 90 minutes when the passenger taps the same card or uses the same mobile ticket account.

Reduced fare

Eligible students and seniors pay 1.25 Metro Credits after their eligibility is verified and linked to their transit card.

Children and validity

Children under six travel free with a fare-paying adult; one adult may accompany up to three children under six. A ticket must be valid when the journey begins and cannot be transferred to another person after use.

Transit Cards and Mobile Tickets

MetroCard

The MetroCard is a reloadable contactless card. Tap at metro gates or bus validators. A green light and short beep mean the tap succeeded; a red light means it was not accepted.

Mobile ticket

The official Metroville Transit app stores mobile tickets. Activate a ticket immediately before entering the paid area or boarding. Keep the active ticket visible if an inspector asks.

One account and balance

Use the same card or mobile account throughout a journey to receive the 90-minute transfer benefit. Balance can be checked at station vending machines, customer service desks, or in the app after registration.

Passes and Fare Caps

Day Pass

The Day Pass costs 7.00 Metro Credits and is valid until 2:00 a.m. after the day of first use. It covers unlimited standard metro and local bus travel but not the weekend ferry.

Weekly Pass

The Weekly Pass costs 28.00 Metro Credits and is valid for seven consecutive calendar days from the selected start date. It covers metro, local buses, and express buses.

Daily cap and limitations

At 7.00 Metro Credits in eligible single-journey fares during a service day, additional eligible metro and local bus journeys are free until 2:00 a.m. Passes are personal. The Day Pass excludes express buses, the ferry, and special event shuttles.

Service Hours and Frequency

Metro hours

Monday through Thursday, metro service runs 5:30 a.m. to midnight. Friday and Saturday service runs until 1:30 a.m. Sunday service ends at midnight.

Bus hours

Most local buses operate 5:00 a.m. to 11:30 p.m. Routes 14 and 22 have limited overnight service on Friday and Saturday. Check the route timetable for exact departures.

Frequency and holidays

Weekday peak metro trains generally arrive every 6 minutes, midday about every 10 minutes, and late evening about every 15 minutes. Public holidays may use a Sunday timetable; special event notices can override normal schedules.

Accessibility and Assisted Travel

Step-free stations

Step-free access is available at Northgate, Museum Square, Central Exchange, Civic Center, West Park, University, and East Market. Other stations may have stairs only.

Elevators and assistance

Elevator status is posted in the app and at station entrances. If an elevator is out of service, staff can suggest an accessible alternative. Passengers can use station help points or ask uniformed staff for boarding assistance.

Priority seating

Priority seats are intended for passengers who need them, including people with disabilities, older adults, and pregnant passengers. For planned group assistance, contact the accessibility team at least 24 hours in advance.

Bicycles, Strollers, and Large Items

Bicycles on trains

Standard bicycles are allowed on metro trains outside weekday peak hours, 7:00–9:00 a.m. and 4:00–6:00 p.m. Folded bicycles are allowed at all times if they do not block aisles.

Buses and bicycle parking

Bicycles are not carried inside buses. Riverside Station has bicycle lockers that can be rented by the hour or day.

Strollers and large items

Strollers are allowed on buses and trains; keep aisles clear and apply brakes when stationary. Items must not obstruct exits or occupy priority seating. Staff may refuse unsafe or excessively large items.

Passenger Conduct and Safety

General conduct

Do not block doors, run on platforms, or lean over platform edges. Keep bags close and allow passengers to exit before boarding.

Prohibited behavior

Smoking, vaping, littering, and loud audio without headphones are prohibited in stations and vehicles. Harassment or threatening behavior may result in removal from the network.

Emergencies and suspicious items

Use emergency intercoms for immediate safety concerns or medical emergencies, not routine timetable questions. Do not touch suspicious unattended items; move away and notify staff or use a station help point.

Delays, Cancellations, and Disruptions

Service alerts

The official app, station display boards, and transit website publish alerts about delays, station closures, replacement buses, and planned maintenance.

Alternative travel

During a metro suspension, replacement buses may operate between affected stations. Follow signs and staff directions because replacement stops may be outside the station entrance.

Disruption review

A passenger may request a disruption review if a cancellation caused an eligible journey to be abandoned. Submit the request within 14 calendar days. A refund is not automatic.

Lost Property

Report an item

Submit a lost-property report through the app or at a customer service desk. Include date, approximate time, route or station, item description, and a contact method.

Found items and collection

Staff log found items and transfer them to the Central Exchange lost-property office. Processing can take up to two business days. To collect an item, describe it accurately and bring photo identification.

Retention

Unclaimed items are retained for 30 calendar days after being logged. Perishable food, hazardous materials, and items prohibited by law may be handled differently for safety.

Refunds and Fare Corrections

Duplicate charge

If a registered card appears to have been charged twice for one journey, submit a fare review within 30 calendar days. Include the card's last four digits, journey time, and station or route.

Failed tap

If a reader rejects a tap, try once more and check its message. If the problem continues, use another gate or speak with staff before entering the paid area.

Mobile ticket issue and timing

If a purchased mobile ticket cannot be displayed because of an app error, show purchase confirmation to staff. Fare reviews normally finish within 10 business days; approved refunds return to the original payment method when possible.

Customer Support and Complaints

Contact options

Ask at station customer service desks, submit a report through the app, or call the fictional Metroville Transit Support Line at 555-0148.

Support hours

Telephone support is available daily from 6:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m. App reports can be submitted any time but are reviewed during support hours.

Complaints and response targets

Include date, time, route or station, description, and requested outcome. Do not include full payment-card details or passwords. Routine complaints are acknowledged within two business days; complex cases may take up to 15 business days.

Traveling with Children and Groups

Children

Children under six travel free with a fare-paying adult. Children aged six and older need a valid ticket or eligible reduced-fare product.

School groups

Groups of 10 or more should submit a group travel request at least five business days before travel, including date, approximate time, route, group size, and accessibility needs.

Meeting point and supervision

Central Exchange's customer service desk is the designated meeting point for groups needing help. Group leaders must manage headcounts and keep children together; staff cannot provide individual supervision.

Weekend Ferry and Special Services

Ferry schedule

The weekend ferry runs between Harbor Point Pier and Riverside Landing on Saturdays and Sundays from 9:00 a.m. to 7:00 p.m., weather permitting.

Ferry fare and weather

A one-way ferry ticket costs 3.50 Metro Credits. Metro Day Passes and the daily metro/bus fare cap do not cover ferry travel. High winds, lightning, or unsafe water may suspend service.

Event shuttles

Special event shuttles are announced separately and may require an event ticket. Standard passes do not automatically cover event shuttle service.

Parking and Park-and-Ride

Facilities

Park-and-ride lots are available at Northgate, West Park, and East Market. Parking availability is not guaranteed, especially on weekday mornings.

Fees

Parking costs 2.00 Metro Credits per day at Northgate and West Park. East Market parking is free on weekends and costs 1.50 Metro Credits on weekdays.

Payment and accessible spaces

Pay at the kiosk or through the app before leaving and keep the receipt. Accessible spaces are near step-free entrances and reserved for vehicles displaying a valid accessibility permit.

Fares: Examples and Common Mistakes

Transfer example

A passenger taps a MetroCard for a metro journey at 8:10 a.m. and boards a local bus at 8:55 a.m. using the same card. The bus transfer is within 90 minutes, so no additional standard fare is charged.

Separate payment

If the passenger pays for the metro with a MetroCard and pays cash on the bus, the system cannot link the trips, so separate fares may be charged.

Pass example

A Day Pass covers eligible metro and local bus journeys until 2:00 a.m. after first use, but a separate ferry ticket is required. A green reader light confirms a successful tap; red or error means the passenger should not assume payment succeeded.

Planning a Reliable Journey

Before leaving

Check service alerts, first and last departures, elevator availability if needed, and whether the fare product covers every planned mode.

Transfer buffer and peak periods

Allow at least 10 minutes for transfers at Central Exchange during busy periods. Weekday peaks are generally 7:00–9:00 a.m. and 4:00–6:00 p.m.; vehicles may be crowded and standard bicycles are restricted on metro trains.

Missed connections

Check the next departure and service alerts before changing route. Staff can suggest alternatives but cannot guarantee a specific arrival time.

Quick Reference and Frequently Asked Questions

Standard fare

2.50 Metro Credits for a single adult journey, with linked transfers within 90 minutes.

Customer service and lost items

The customer service desk is at Central Exchange. Lost items are retained for 30 calendar days after being logged.

Disruption review

Submit a disruption review within 14 calendar days. Refunds are not automatic.

Contact support

Call 555-0148 from 6:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m., visit a customer service desk, or submit an app report.

Step-free access

Northgate, Museum Square, Central Exchange, Civic Center, West Park, University, and East Market have step-free access.

Glossary and RAG Practice Notes

Paid area

The part of a metro station beyond fare gates where a valid ticket or pass is required.

Fare cap

A limit on the total eligible single-journey fares charged during a service day.

Replacement bus

A bus service temporarily operating in place of a suspended rail segment.

Business day

A weekday excluding public holidays for the response targets in this fictional guide.

RAG exercise

Test retrieval on fares, hours, accessibility, refunds, lost property, and route rules. For information not contained in the source, the system should say the document does not provide it rather than inventing an answer.